

Frugality Makes the Heart Grow Fonder: 5 Ways to Spend Less and Love More

Hot dates are often stereotyped as being expensive. Fine wines, fancy dinners, high-priced hotels, and posh resorts top the list of ways to reconnect with our significant other. Even though frugality isn't generally considered sexy, it can bring about intimacy in unexpected ways.

1. Share a ride

I know a young married couple who work in the same building and share the same work schedule with each other. They also commute 45 miles every day separately! The fact that they don't carpool blows my mind. When asked why they wouldn't share

a ride to save on gas and car expenses, the answer is simply, "We don't like spending that much time together." It's surprising they're married at all!

Carpooling can be a great opportunity to discuss the day's events, catch up on an audiobook together, or just sit in silence and enjoy the scenery. Done daily, it can bring a couple closer without really trying.

2. Split a plate

Saving money while eating out can be difficult. It is so tempting to order two oversized meals that you will never finish. Try sharing a plate. You can even use the same fork and feed each other. (Just get a table near the back where it isn't as obvious, please.) If you encounter uppity restaurant policies that prohibit plate-splitting, have one person order a side salad as their main course, and split that, too. Sharing gives you the chance to experience the same foods from a different perspective.

3. Divide the work

Sure, I could sit inside doing my housework while hubby is in the yard doing his, but why? I know that I could help him somehow (stacking firewood, raking leaves, etc.), and he enjoys my company. By doing our